Paride Carrara

paride.carrara@gmail.com paridecarrara.com paride-carrara

Employment History

2025 – ongoing **Postdoctoral Researcher.** WICE (ERC Project), Faculty of Economics and Social Sciences, University of Latvia.

2024 – ongoing **Adjunct Professor.** Polimetrics, Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan.

2025 – 2025 **Research Assistant.** University of Bologna. Prof. Filippo Tronconi

2023 – 2023 **Research Assistant.** "The Politics of Portfolio Allocation" University of Bamberg. Prof. Sieberer Ulrich

2022 – 2022 **Research Assistant.** "Crime and State making in Europe" University of Bologna. Prof. Francesco Moro.

2019 – 2020 **Research Assistant.** "Politics by Denunciation" Columbia University. Prof. Francesca Invernizzi.

Freelance Fact Checker. "Pagella Politica, Milan.

2017 – 2028 **Editorial Assistant.** "Politeia" University of Milan

Education

11/2020 – 06/2025 **Ph.D., Alma Mater Studiorum - University of Bologna** in Political and Social Sciences.

- PhD Dissertation: “The Determinants and Consequences of Ideological Ambiguity: Strategies, Electoral Impact, and Coalition Formation” (Defence: 16/06/2025)
- Supervisor: prof. Luca Pinto; co-Supervisor: prof. Daniela Giannetti; Defence committee chair: prof. Luigi Curini, prof. Filippo Tronconi, prof. Elisa Volpi.

01/2023 – 06/2023 **Visiting Fellow, London School of Economics (LSE)** Data Science Institute (DSI).

- Supervisor: prof. Kenneth Benoit

09/2016 – 03/2019 **Master’s Degree, University of Milan** in Political Science and Government.

- Title: "Politica e Bugie. Fact Checking e Incentivi dei Politici a Mentire in USA e Italia"
- supervisor: prof. Alessia Damonte
- co-supervisor: prof. Andrea Ceron

09/2011 – 07/2015 **Bachelor’s Degree, , University of Milan** in Cultural and Linguistic Mediation.

- Title: Repubblica Popolare Cinese e Hong Kong: dalla Basic Law alle proteste popolari"
- supervisor: prof. Francesco Montessoro

Teaching

02/2024 – ongoing **Adjunct Professor**. Polimetrics. University of Milan.

- Intro to R and Automated Text Analysis

11/06/2024 **XML Parsing**. Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS) Bologna

12/06/2024 **Automated Text Analysis: Scaling Methods** Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS) Bologna.

10/2024 – ongoing **Teaching Assistant** in Political Behaviour and Institutions, University of Bologna.

10/2022 – 09/2024 **Teaching Assistant** in Polimetrics, University of Milan.

02/2024 – 10/2024 **Teaching Assistant** in Italian Political System, University of Milan.

Research Publications

Journal Articles

1. F. Bromo, P. Carrara, P. Gambacciani, and E. A. Viganò, "Reduced incentives, reduced party unity: Evidence from parliamentary speeches," EN, *Party Politics*, p. 13 540 688 261 427 363, Feb. 2026, ISSN: 1354-0688. DOI: 10.1177/13540688261427363 Accessed: Mar. 25, 2026.
2. P. Carrara, P. Gambacciani, and L. Pinto, "How party ideology and constituency risk shape MPs' speeches on climate change," EN, *West European Politics*, pp. 1–28, 2026, ISSN: 0140-2382. DOI: 10.1080/01402382.2026.2692128 Accessed: Mar. 25, 2026.
3. A. Scopelliti, P. Carrara, and F. Marolla, "Antilgbtqism: How Far-right Ideas Become Mainstream Through Policy Debate," eng, *Rivista Italiana di Politiche Pubbliche*, vol. 1, no. 2025, pp. 109–139, 2025, ISSN: 1722-1137. DOI: 10.1483/116166 Accessed: Jun. 11, 2025.
4. A. Ceron and P. Carrara, "Fact-checking, reputation, and political falsehoods in Italy and the United States," en, *New Media & Society*, p. 14 614 448 211 012 377, May 2021, ISSN: 1461-4448. DOI: 10.1177/14614448211012377 Accessed: Jun. 7, 2021.

Books and Chapters

1. P. Carrara and L. Pinto, "Data sources for the study of political representation in Europe and North America," in *Elgar encyclopedia*, ser. Elgar encyclopedias in the social sciences series, A. Freire, E. H. Önnudóttir, A. Pedrazzani, and H. Schmitt, Eds., Northampton: Edward Elgar Publishing, 2026, pp. 222–230, ISBN: 978-1-0353-2481-1. DOI: https://doi.org/10.4337/9781035324828.00049

NLP Models and Software

1. P. Carrara, *Ideobert-it-detect: A fine-tuned italian bert model for detecting ideologically loaded sentences in parliamentary speech.(forthcoming)*, 2026.
2. P. Carrara, *Ideobert-it-scaling: A fine-tuned italian bert model for scaling parliamentary sentences on the general left–right ideological dimension.(forthcoming)*, 2026.
3. P. Carrara, *Italyparlr. an r package to access italian parliament open data via sparql.* 2026.
4. S. Luck and P. Carrara, *Feel-ic-ita-emotion: Emotion Classification for the Italian Journalistic Language (forthcoming)*, 2025.
5. S. Luck and P. Carrara, *Feel-ic-ita-sentiment: Sentiment Analysis for the Italian Journalistic Language (forthcoming)*, 2025.

Working Papers

2024 **The Politics of Banditry: Political Change and Criminal Violence in Post-Unification Italy (1861–1865)**. Carrara, P.; Knap, A.; Moro, F.; Pinto, L.

2023 **Intra-Party Negativity and Criticism of Party Leaders in Italy**. Carrara, P.; Ceron, A.; Scopelliti, A.

Summer and Winter Schools

23/02/2026 – 27/02/2026 **Konstanz Methods Excellence Workshops (KOMEX) 2026**.

- Survey Experiments

3/09/2025 **Crash Course SISP**

- Conjoint Experiments in Political Science and International Relations

05/02/2024 – 09/02/2024 **ECPR Methods School winter programme**. (Online)

- Applied Regression Analysis: Estimation, Diagnostics, and Modelling

08/08/2022 – 13/08/2022 **Summer School of the ECPR Standing Group on Political Parties**. Aarhus University.

20/06/2021 – 01/07/2021 **Summer Institutes in Computational Social Science 2021**. University of Bologna (Online)

13/06/2021 – 18/06/2021 **EITM Europe 2021**. University of Mannheim (Online)

23/06/2022 – 25/06/2022 **Summer School "Big Data for Better Policies (?)"**. University of Milan.

Conferences and Seminars

18/06/2026 – 20/06/2026 **SISP 2026**. University of Trento.

- Presenter "Cheap, Fast, and Replicable: A Two-Step LLM-to-BERT Approach to Ideological Scaling of Political Text"

EPSS 2026. Belfast.

- Presenter "Intra-party negativity and criticism of party leaders in Italy"

07/04/2026 – 10/04/2026 **ECPR Joint Sessions 2026**. University of Innsbruck.

- Panel: "Blurring or Accident? Voluntary and Involuntary Sources of Ambiguous Party Positions and Their Consequences for Democracy"
- Presenter "Ambiguous Coalitions: How parties' ideological ambiguity impact government formation"

26/06/2025 – 28/06/2025 **SISP 2025**. University of Naples Federico II.

- Presenter "Ambiguous Coalitions: How parties' ideological ambiguity impact government formation"
- Co-author "Parliamentary Speeches and Re-Election Incentives"
- Co-author "Why do MPs prioritise environmental hazards and natural disasters when speaking about the environment?"

Conferences and Seminars (continued)

EPSA 2025. University Carlos III of Madrid.

- Presenter "Ideological Ambiguity and Valence: A Joint Strategy for Political Success?"
- Co-author "Parliamentary Speeches and Re-Election Incentives"

12/09/2024 – 14/09/2024 **SISP 2024**. Trieste University.

- Co-author "Words of dissent: How content analysis of legislative speeches can improve the study of party switching"
- Co-author "Anti-LGBT discourses: how far-right ideas become mainstream through policy debate"

25/06/2024 – 28/06/2024 **NOPSA 2024**. Bergen University.

- Presenter "Words of dissent: How content analysis of legislative speeches can improve the study of party switching"

14/09/2023 – 16/09/2023 **SISP 2023**. Genova University.

- Presenter ""Don't mind me; It is the elite!" How parties' anti-elitism salience explains issue blurring"

04/09/2023 – 08/09/2023 **ECPR 2023**. Innsbruck University.

- Presenter "Intra-party negativity and criticism of party leader in Italy."

08/09/2022 – 10/09/2022 **SISP 2022**. Sapienza University, Rome.

- Presenter "How much commitment? The role of intra-party politics on the ambiguity of electoral pledges."

23/06/2022 – 25/06/2022 **EPSA 2022**. Prague.

- Presenter "How much commitment? The role of intra-party politics on the ambiguity of electoral pledges."

Academic Activities

11/06/2024 – 21/06/2024 **Co-Organizer of the Bologna (host location) Summer Institute in Computational Social Sciences (SICSS).**

09/2023 – ongoing **Co-Organizer of the Quantitative Social Science Seminars (QSSS) - University of Bologna.**

09/2021 – ongoing **Member of the PRIN Project Democracy under Pressure (DEMOPE). University of Bologna's unit.**

Skills

Languages Strong reading, writing and speaking competencies for English. Intermediate level of Spanish. Beginner level Chinese.

Coding R, STATA, Python, ODK, XML/XSL, LaTeX, Microsoft Excel, Microsoft SharePoint.

Computing HPC cluster computing for large-scale NLP tasks; experience running and fine-tuning LLMs on GPU clusters (SLURM job scheduling).